

GUZMANIA

Guzmania cultivars

I have used this striking South American plant in many interior design landscapes that I've created over the years, because it gives so much positive energy in its structure and vibrant colors. The other main benefit is that the rosette-shaped, flowerlike bracts, or modified leaves, stay bright red for such a long time with minimal upkeep.

“Try me if you're looking for a pop of color.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

Grows well in high humidity and in indirect sunlight—direct sunlight will burn the leaves. Keep temperatures above 60°F (15°C).



POTTING

Likes to grow in a rich, free-draining potting mix along with equal amounts of chopped sphagnum moss.



GROWTH RATE

Some varieties can reach 2ft (60cm) tall and 4ft (1.2m) wide; they are fairly slow-growing and long-lived, but once they've flowered, they will die.



CARE

Quarter-fill the central urn with rain or distilled water in summer and refresh monthly. In winter, water sparingly to keep soil moist.



I'll clean your air

My leaves remove air pollutants such as benzene, which is found in glue and paint, and release oxygen at night. This makes me ideal for the bedroom as I will purify the air while you sleep so you wake feeling bright and refreshed.



My flowers are hard to spot as they don't rise above my bracts



Let's make babies

I am monocarpic, which means I die after my true flowers have bloomed. But I can be easily propagated from the offsets that grow at my base. When the pups get to 4–6in (10–15cm), they can be cut away and planted into a free-draining potting mix.